

Connect 2.0 Journeys

Every path a student or a professional can take through the Connect tab, what happens at each step, where it breaks, and what is built on the connect-2-0 branch versus proposed.

Dreamari prototype · branch connect-2-0 · 3 September 2026 · source brief: DREAMARI
CONNECT 2.pdf

One rule ranks everything else: the least information that still does the job. An 8th grader should never have to work out what a screen is for.

Who lands on Connect

PERSON	ARRIVES WITH	WANTS	FEAR
New student, 13 to 15	Nothing yet, maybe a Match Top 3	To ask one real question and see who does the job	Looking dumb in public, strangers
Returning student	Top 3, a question they asked, people they follow	Did anyone answer me? What did my people post?	Missing the answer, having to dig
Event attendee	An event code from JA or Dream Opportunity	The room for the event they went to	Losing the code
Professional, Founding 150	A verified account, ten minutes a week	One question worth answering, proof it mattered	Obligation, being judged for volunteering rarely
Partner or employer, later	Sponsorship	Company-level proof of impact	Nothing to show

The one loop

Every screen exists to move one step of this loop. Nothing on the tab is there for its own sake.

- 1 Student asks**
From the landing, a board or a profile.
 - 2 Dreamari routes it**
To the verified pros in the right community.
 - 3 A pro answers in minutes**
Answer or Skip, never an obligation.
 - 4 Students read, like, save, follow**
One answer helps every student who reads it.
 - 5 The pro sees the impact, privately**
Then the next relevant question arrives.
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The landing, top to bottom

- 1 Find your community, Community / Events toggle, search**
Unchanged from the approved design.
 - 2 Your questions**
The tab's one primary action, Ask a question, sits in this panel's header. Rows are the student's own questions with one or two words of status: New answer, Answered, Waiting for an answer. The last row opens Saved. A student who has never asked sees one sentence and the button. A returning student's whole reason for coming is answered in one glance.
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3**Your Communities**

The doors. The approved photo cards with stat tiles, Pros from logos and the ghost action.

4**People to Follow**

Below the communities. Instagram's suggestion shape: portrait, name, what they do, the company as its logo, Follow. Nothing else. Ranked relevance first from the Match Top 3, activity second.

5**New from people you follow**

Appears only after the first follow. Up to four rows: who, answered or posted, the title.

People come after places because a student's first question is "where do I ask about nursing", not "which nurse". The community answers that. The rail then makes the community human, and Following gives a reason to come back.

Journeys

1. First visit with a Top 3**BUILT**

Home → Connect. Your questions in its empty state with the Ask button, the communities matching the Top 3 already joined, People to Follow labelled "Picked for your Top 3". Taps Ask.

2. First visit without a Top 3**COPY DECISION**

Same screen. The rail falls back to quality and activity and drops its label. Proposed: one line under the rail, "Pick your Top 3 in Match and we will pick people for you", linking to Match.

3. Ask a question

BUILT

Three entry points, one behaviour: the landing's Ask button, the composer on a community board, the Ask Me Anything composer on a profile. The Ask sheet picks where the question goes from its words ("bank" sends it to Finance Careers) and one tap on a chip changes that. When a question with the same words was already answered, up to two "Already answered" rows appear above Post, so one tap reads the answer with no waiting. Phone numbers, emails, @handles and DM apps block Post with a plain sentence and keep the draft. After Post, a toast says where it went and the usual wait, and the question appears under Your questions as Waiting.

4. Waiting, then a new answer

BUILT

STILL WAITING STATE NEEDS BACKEND

Waiting: the row says so, the thread says where the question went and how long it usually takes. Answered: the row flips to New answer in green. The thread shows the primary answer marked, likes by the question, Like, Save and Report under each answer. Proposed for later: after the community's window passes, "Still waiting. We asked more pros." with a link to similar answered questions.

5. Follow a professional

BUILT

From the rail, a profile, or any name in a badge, an insight card or a comment. Follow flips to Following and the count ticks. New from people you follow appears on the landing. Students follow pros; there is no reverse.

6. Browse a community

BUILT EARLIER

Card → board with Feed (Student Questions, Professional Insights) and About (purpose, topics, Pros from logos, response window). Not joined → Join sheet: what you get, one ground rule, Agree and Join.

7. Save

BUILT

Save on any question, answer or post. The toast used to say "Find it under Saved" and Saved did not exist. It does now: Your questions → Saved answers and posts → one panel of rows (Question, Answer by, Post by, Event takeaways).

8. Event attendee

BUILT EARLIER

Events tab → event card → Enter Code → the board unlocks and stays under Your events.

9. Report

BUILT

Report on a thread or an answer opens a sheet with four reasons and Send report, then a toast: "Thanks. A moderator will look at it." The reporter is never revealed. Report was inert before.

10. Professional: routed question to answer

BUILT AS PREVIEW

"Three students asked questions about investment banking this week. Answer one?" Each routed question is a row with Answer and Skip. Answer opens a three-line composer; Post answer shows "Live on Finance Careers" with a link to the thread, and Questions Answered ticks up. Skip: "Skipped. Nothing changes." The headline counts down as questions are handled. Reached at /connect?dashboard=pro; no student entry point.

11. Professional: posts, impact, recognition

BUILT AS PREVIEW

Career posts from four prompts, optional. Private Impact Dashboard with the brief's six numbers, the positive activity sentence, "Active weekly. Only you can see this.", and the company line with the company's logo. 2026 Impact Summary with Download and who to share it with.

Edge cases and empty states

CASE	WHAT HAPPENS
Never asked anything	Your questions shows one sentence and the Ask button
Asked, nobody answered yet	Row says Waiting for an answer; the thread says where it went and the usual wait
Question already answered by someone else	Ask sheet shows it before Post; one tap reads it
Question contains contact details	Post is blocked with a plain reason; the draft is kept
Not joined, tries to ask on a board	Join sheet first
Follows nobody	No Following section; the rail is the invitation
Follows people with nothing new	Following section hides itself
No Top 3	Rail ranks by quality and activity; no "Picked for your Top 3" label
Nothing saved	Saved view says how to save
Company with no exact logo	Text chip at the same size (none today; Goldman Sachs and Blackstone marks added)
Wrong event code	Inline error in the code sheet
Upcoming event	Card says the board opens after the event

Pain points in the previous Connect

PAIN	STATUS

Asking was two levels deep	Fixed: Ask from the landing, routed by the words
No way to see your own questions or whether anyone answered	Fixed: Your questions panel
"Find it under Saved" but no Saved anywhere	Fixed: Saved view
Report buttons did nothing	Fixed: Report sheet with confirmation
People cards repeated the role, a field chip and a follower count	Fixed: portrait, name, role, logo, Follow
People rail sat above the communities	Fixed: below
Pill-shaped composer and chips	Fixed: 12px composer, 8px chips
Following did nothing after the count ticked	Fixed: New from people you follow
Pro "Answer" was a one-line message, not a flow	Fixed: routed rows with a real composer
Company names as text where a logo exists	Fixed: logos in chips, profiles, badges, insight cards, dashboard

Safety by design, visible

- Students follow pros; pros never follow students; students have no follower counts anywhere.
- No message entry point exists. Every composer says answers are public.
- Contact details are blocked at the composer.
- Report is one tap away on every thread and answer, with a confirmation.
- Pros see a grade, never a full name, and every composer footer says so.
- A verification line on every profile.

Copy rules for an 8th grader

One idea per line. Say what happens next: "Sent to verified pros in Finance Careers."
Status is one or two words. No system words such as routed, moderation queue or entitlement. No em dashes.

Deferred, needs backend or a decision

Real routing and the time-based Still waiting state. Persisted follows, saves and questions. A notification badge on the Connect tab. Pro login and the real dashboard. Anonymized outcomes such as "18 students you supported graduated". Company-level aggregation. The invite flow for the Founding 150.

Alignment with the CEO's Replit

dceai.replit.app, read 3 September 2026. Design ignored on purpose; the flows and elements are what matter so ours line up with his mental model.

REPLIT ELEMENT	OURS
Connect header trust line, "Verified professionals · Moderated questions"	Safety line in every composer and on profiles. Worth one trust line under the Connect title
Communities / People as two tabs; People has filters and three rails (Recommended, Popular This Week, New Professionals)	One ranked rail under the communities, relevance first. Filters and extra rails skipped for load
Person card with initials, role, company, View profile, Follow, "18.4K students reached · 3.2K followers"	Portrait, name, role, company logo, Follow. Counts live on the profile
Enter Community only shows a toast; no board yet	Full boards: Student Questions, Professional Insights, About
Profile tabs Ask Me Anything / Posts / About; Report on each answer; View discussion	Same numbers and AMA. About (education, career journey, topics) not built; a good folded section to add

Volunteer dashboard, My Profile: "64 asked · 58 answered", questions with Awaiting / Answered, My Posts with Create Post, the pro's communities	Routed questions with Answer / Skip and an inline composer; post prompts. Asked/answered counter and the pro's communities not shown
Volunteer dashboard, My Impact: six numbers with percent change each, 30-day chart, "Your advice is moving people forward", Gold volunteer status with "no penalty for taking a break"	Six numbers, one overall change, the positive sentence, "Active weekly. Only you can see this." Per-number deltas and chart skipped; tier stays private per the brief
Corporate Partnership Dashboard: Export; Overview, Financial Oversight, DO Events, DCAI Mentorship, Impact Quality; goals vs targets; in-person vs virtual; events with fill; budget; regional growth; satisfaction	Partner view: Export, 2026 goals with progress, In person vs On Dreamari lanes, events, professionals, satisfaction line. Budget and regions left out
Student My Profile: Top 3, Plan, Career Report, "Do this next", Coming up	Matches our Profile; "Do this next" is the Home proposal's next-step line
Not in the Replit yet: Saved, Report with reasons, the Ask sheet with routing and already-answered matches, New from people you follow, event code boards. Those come from the brief and the earlier handoff.	

Demo switch

A segmented control tops every Connect screen: Student · Event attendee · Volunteer · Partner. It rides the URL as ?as=, so each journey has a link.

Home page: evaluation and proposal

What Home does today

- A three-panel hero carousel: Today's Drop, Continue the simulation, a trending career.
- A Continue rail of three activity cards.
- A rail of recommended careers, identical to Explore's.
- The Your Signal banner to the Career Report.

Where it underserves

- Two of three hero panels repeat what sits directly below. Carousels are the least-read element on any home page.
- Nothing from Connect reaches Home. A student with an answer waiting has no idea.
- Nothing about the student's spine, Build → Match → Top 3 → Play. Before and after Match look the same.
- "View all activity" goes nowhere.

Proposal, same length, less to read

1 Hero, one panel, state-aware

Today's Drop stays as the hero, it is the daily habit. Under it, one line for the next step in the spine: "Finish Match to get your Top 3" or "Continue: The \$30B Deal, 18 min left". No carousel.

2 Continue rail

Keep as is.

3 From Connect

One panel, up to three rows: new answers to your questions, new from people you follow. Empty state: "Ask a pro anything" with the Ask button. This is where the Connect loop earns a return visit.

4 Your Top 3

Three poster cards with a one-line progress each (played, glossary, asked). Replaces the recommended rail; Explore keeps the recommendations.

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Your Signal banner

Keep.

Not built. It changes an approved Home, so it waits for a go-ahead.